SPECIFICATION OF THE PROTECTED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN "CORBIÈRES"

approved by decree no. 2011-1800 of 6 December 2011, amended by decree no. 2013-1094 of 29 November 2013, published in the JORF of 3 December 2013

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may benefit from the controlled designation of origin "Corbières", initially recognised by the decree of 24 December 1985.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

No particular provision.

III. – Colours and types of product

The controlled designation of origin "Corbières" is reserved for still white, red and rosé wines.

IV. – Geographical area and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification and the elaboration of the wines are carried out within the territory of the following communes of the Aude department on the basis of the official geographic code of the year 2019: Albas, Arquettes-en-Val, Bages, Barbaira, Bizanet, Boutenac, Camplong-d'Aude, Canet, Capendu, Cascastel-des-Corbières, Caunettes-en-Val, Caves, Comigne, Conilhac-Corbières, Coustouge, Cruscades, Cucugnan, Davejean, Dernacueillette, Douzens, Duilhac-sous-Peyreperthuse, Durban-Corbières, Embres-et-Castelmaure, Escales, Fabrezan, Felines-Termenès, Ferrals-les-Corbières, Feuilla, Fitou, Floure, Fontcouverte, Fontiès-d'Aude, Fontjoncouse, Fraisse-des-Corbières, Gruissan, Jonquières, Labastide-en-Val, Lagrasse, Laroque-de-Fa, Leucate, Lézignan-Corbières, Luc-sur-Orbieu, Mayronnes, Maisons, Montbrun-des-Corbières, Montgaillard, Montirat, Montlaur, Montredon-des-Corbières, Montséret, Monze, Moux, Narbonne, Névian, Ornaisons, Padern, Palairac, La Palme, Paziols, Peyriac-de-Mer, Port-la-Nouvelle, Portel-des-Corbières, Pradelles-en-Val, Quintillan, Ribaute, Rieux-en-Val, Roquefort-des-Corbières, Rouffiac-des-Corbières, Saint-André-de-Roquelongue, Saint-Jean-de-Barrou, Saint-Laurent-de-la-Cabrerisse, Saint-Pierre-des-Champs, Serviès-en-Val, Sigean, Talairan, Taurize, Termes, Thézan-des-Corbières, Tournissan, Treilles, Tuchan, Vignevieille, Villar-en-Val, Villeneuve-les-Corbières, Villerouge-Termenès, Villesèque-des-Corbières, Villetritouls.

2° – Delimited parcel area

The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 11 and 12 September 1985, 5 and 6 November 1985, 17 September 1986, 5 and 6 June 2002 and 19 May 2011. The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in point 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification and the elaboration of the wines, is made up of the territory of the following communes on the basis of the official geographic code of the year 2019:

- Aude department: Argens-Minervois, Armissan, Auriac, Badens, Blomac, Bouilhonnac, Carcassonne, Castelnau-d'Aude, Clermont-sur-Lauquet, Coursan, Cuxac-d'Aude, Fajac-en-Val, Fleury, Greffeil, Ladern-sur-Lauquet, Lairière, Mailhac, Marcorignan, Marseillette, Mas-des-Cours, Massac, Montjoi, Moussan, Mouthoumet, Palaja, Paraza, Puicheric, Raissac-d'Aude, Roquecourbe-Minervois, Roubia, Rustiques, Saint-Couat-d'Aude, Saint-Martin-des-Puits, Soulatgé, Tourouzelle, Trèbes, Villedaigne, Vinassan;

- Pyrénées-Orientales department: Le Barcarès, Maury, Opoul-Perillos, Rivesaltes, Saint-Paul-de-Fenouillet, Salses-le-Château, Tautavel, Vingrau.

V. – Grape varieties

The grape varieties are understood as those of all of the parcels of the holding producing wines of the controlled designation of origin, for the colour considered.

1° – Grape varieties

The wines come from the following varieties:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	GRAPE VARIETIES
Red wines	- main varieties: carignan N, grenache N, lledoner pelut N, mourvèdre N, syrah N; - accessory varieties: cinsaut N, grenache gris G, piquepoul noir N, terret noir N and marselan N (subject to the signature, between the INAO, the ODG and the accredited operator concerned, of an agreement conforming to the framework agreement approved by the competent national committee).
Rosé wines	- main varieties: carignan N, cinsaut N, grenache N, lledoner pelut N, mourvèdre N, piquepoul noir N, syrah N; - accessory varieties: bourboulenc B, carignan blanc B, clairette B, grenache blanc B, grenache gris G, macabeu B, marsanne B, muscat à petits grains B, piquepoul blanc B, piquepoul noir N, roussanne B, terret blanc B, terret noir N, vermentino B, viognier B.
White wines	- main varieties: bourboulenc B, grenache blanc B, macabeu B, marsanne B, roussanne B, vermentino B; - accessory varieties: carignan blanc B, clairette B, muscat à petits grains B, piquepoul blanc B, terret blanc B, viognier B.

2° – Proportion rules on the holding

COLOUR OF THE WINES	PROPORTION RULES ON THE HOLDING
GENERAL PROVISIONS	
Red wines	- The grape varieties comprise at least 2 varieties. - The proportion of the grenache N, lledoner pelut N, mourvèdre N and syrah N varieties, together or separately, is greater than or equal to 50 % of the grape varieties. - The proportion of the carignan N, piquepoul noir N and terret noir N varieties, together or separately, is less than or equal to 50 % of the grape varieties. - The proportion of the cinsaut N variety is less than or equal to 20 % of the grape varieties. - The proportion of the other accessory varieties, together or separately, is less than 10 % of the grape varieties. - The proportion of the marselan N variety is less than or equal to 5 %.
Rosé wines	- The grape varieties comprise at least 2 varieties. - The proportion of the cinsaut, grenache N, lledoner pelut N, mourvèdre N, piquepoul noir N and syrah N varieties, together or separately, is greater than or equal to 50 % of the grape varieties. - The proportion of the cinsaut N variety is less than or equal to 75 % of the grape varieties. - The proportion of all the carignan N, grenache gris G and terret noir N varieties is less than or equal to 40 % of the grape varieties. - The proportion of the grenache gris G variety is less than or equal to 10 % of the grape varieties. - The proportion of all the bourboulenc B, clairette B, grenache blanc B, macabeu B, marsanne B, muscat à petits grains B, piquepoul blanc B, roussanne B, terret blanc B, vermentino B varieties is less than or equal to 10 % of the grape varieties. - The proportion of the other accessory varieties, together or separately, is less than 10 %, with the exception of the viognier B variety, for which the proportion is less than or equal to 5 % of the grape varieties.
White wines	The grape varieties comprise at least 2 varieties, of which at least one main variety. The proportion of all the accessory varieties clairette B, piquepoul blanc B and terret blanc B is less than or equal to 10 % of the grape varieties. The proportion of each of the muscat à petits grains B and viognier B varieties is less than or equal to 5 % of the grape varieties. The proportion of the carignan B variety is less than or equal to 30 % of the grape varieties.

PARTICULAR PROVISIONS

For the white, red and rosé wines, the provision relating to the obligation to have 2 varieties in the grape varieties of the holding does not apply to operators producing grapes who do not vinify their production, and whose holding: - has an area classified within the delimited parcel area of less than 1.50 hectare; - is planted with one of the following main varieties: grenache N, lledoner N, mourvèdre N or syrah N.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density.

GENERAL PROVISION

The vines present a minimum planting density of 4,000 plants per hectare. These vines may not present a spacing between rows greater than 2.50 metres. Each plant has a maximum area of 2.5 square metres. This area is obtained by multiplying the inter-row and plant-spacing distances within the same row.

PARTICULAR PROVISION

For the vines planted in a square or in a quincunx and trained in goblet, each plant has a maximum area of 3 square metres. This area is obtained by multiplying the inter-row and plant-spacing distances within the same row. The spacing between rows and the spacing between plants within the same row may not be greater than 1.70 metre.

b) – Pruning rules.

TRAINING OF THE VINE, VARIETIES	**PRUNING RULES**
GENERAL PROVISIONS	
Trained in goblet.	The vines are pruned by short pruning with a maximum of 6 spurs per plant. Each spur bears a maximum of 2 free eyes.
Trained in Royat cordon.	The vines are pruned by short pruning: - either with a maximum of 6 spurs per plant, each spur bearing a maximum of 2 free eyes; - or with a maximum of 10 spurs per plant, each spur bearing a maximum of 1 free eye.
PARTICULAR PROVISIONS	
Marsanne B, roussanne B and syrah N varieties.	These varieties may be pruned by single Guyot with a maximum of 10 free eyes per plant: - of which a maximum of 6 free eyes on the long cane and 1 or 2 replacement spurs bearing a maximum of 2 free eyes; - of which a maximum of 8 free eyes on the long cane and 1 replacement spur bearing a maximum of 2 free eyes.
Grenache blanc B and grenache N varieties.	For the plants subject to coulure, a maximum of 3 spurs may be replaced by a long cane bearing a maximum of 5 free eyes.

c) – Trellising rules and foliage height.

GENERAL RULES — PLANTING DENSITY, TRAINING OF THE VINE	**PLANTING DENSITY, TRAINING OF THE VINE**
Vines presenting a minimum planting density of 4,000 plants per hectare.	
Vines trained in the “raised single-plane trellising” mode.	After topping, the height of the trellised foliage must be at least equal to 0.45 times the spacing between rows, the height of trellised foliage being measured between the lower limit of the foliage, established at least 0.30 metre above the ground, and the upper topping limit, established at least 0.20 metre above the upper trellising wire.
Other training methods.	The length of the shoots, after topping, is greater than or equal to 0.70 metre.

Vines planted in a square or in a quincunx and trained in goblet: the foliage height makes it possible to have 1.40 square metres of external surface of plant cover for the production of 1 kilogram of grapes.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel.
- The average maximum load per parcel is fixed at 8,500 kilograms per hectare for the red wines and 9,000 kilograms per hectare for the white wines; - when irrigation is authorised in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, the average maximum load per parcel of the irrigated parcels is fixed at 6,000 kilograms per hectare.

e) – Threshold for missing vines.
The percentage of dead or missing vine plants, referred to in Article 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, is fixed at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine.
The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Irrigation

Irrigation may be authorised in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

The wines come from grapes harvested at proper ripeness.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

a) – Sugar richness of the grapes.
The sugar richness of the grapes meets the following characteristics:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	MINIMUM SUGAR RICHNESS OF THE GRAPES (grams per litre of must)
White wines	178
Rosé wines	198
Red wines	198

b) – Minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume.
The alcoholic strength by volume of the wines meets the following characteristics:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	MINIMUM NATURAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME
White wines	11.5 %
Rosé wines	11.5 %
Red wines	12 %

VIII. – Yields. – Entry into production

1° – Yield

The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	YIELD (hectolitres per hectare)
White and rosé wines	50
Red wines	48

2° – Limit yield

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 60 hectolitres per hectare for the white and rosé wines and at 58 hectolitres per hectare for the red wines.

3° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may be granted to wines coming from: - parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July; - parcels of young vines only from the 1st year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July; - parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By way of derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the grape varieties of each parcel concerned.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local usages.

a) – Blending of the varieties.

COLOUR OF THE WINES	PROVISIONS FOR THE BLENDS
Red wines	- The wines come from the blending of grapes, of musts or of wines arising from at least 2 varieties, of which at least one main variety; - the proportion of the main variety(ies) is greater than or equal to 40 % in the blend; - the proportion of the accessory varieties is less than or equal to 30 %, with the exception of the marselan N variety, for which the proportion is less than or equal to 10 % of the blend; - a variety may not represent more than 80 % of the blend.
Rosé wines	- The wines come from the blending of grapes, of musts or of wines, with the exception of wines arising from white varieties when these are vinified separately, arising from at least 2 varieties of which at least one main variety; - the proportion of the main variety(ies) is greater than or equal to 40 % in the blend; - a variety may not represent more than 80 % of the blend.
White wines	- The wines come from the blending of grapes, of musts or of wines arising from at least 2 varieties, of which at least one of the following varieties: grenache blanc B, macabeu B, marsanne B, roussanne B, vermentino B; - the proportion of the main variety(ies) is greater than or equal to 40 % in the blend; - a variety may not represent more than 80 % of the blend; - the proportion of the carignan blanc variety is less than or equal to 30 % of the blend; - the proportion of the accessory varieties, taken together or separately, is less than or equal to 10 % of the blend, with the exception of the muscat à petits grains B and viognier B varieties, for which individually the proportion is less than or equal to 5 % of the blend.

b) – Malolactic fermentation.

The red wines, ready to be marketed in bulk or packaged, present a malic acid content less than or equal to 0.4 gram per litre.

c) – Analytical standards.

The lots of wines ready to be marketed in bulk or packaged present a content of fermentable sugars (glucose and fructose) meeting the following values:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	MAXIMUM CONTENT OF FERMENTABLE SUGARS (glucose + fructose) (grams per litre)
Red wines (with natural alcoholic strength by volume less than or equal to 14 %)	3

Red wines (with natural alcoholic strength by volume greater than 14 %)	4
Rosé wines	4
White wines	4

d) – Oenological practices and physical treatments.
For the elaboration of the rosé wines, the use of charcoals for oenological use is authorised at the vinifier, at a dose less than or equal to 30 grams per hectolitre for the volume treated, exclusively on the musts arising from pressing and the new wines still in fermentation, and in a proportion that may not be greater than 20 % of the volume of rosé wines elaborated by the vinifier concerned, for the harvest considered.

e) – Prohibited equipment.
The use of continuous vinifiers, continuous presses and centrifugal destemmers (vertical-axis destemmers) is prohibited.

f) – Vinification vat capacity.
Every operator has a vinification vat capacity at least equivalent to the volume vinified during the previous harvest at equal area.

g) – Overall upkeep of the cellar (floors and walls) and equipment.
The cellar (floors and walls) and the vinification equipment present a good general condition of upkeep.

2° – Provisions relating to packaging

For each packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body: - the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code; - an analysis carried out before or after packaging and, in this latter case, within a maximum time limit of 15 days following the packaging. The analysis reports must be kept for a period of 6 months from the date of packaging.

3° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator demonstrates a place suited to the storage of the packaged products.

4° – Provisions relating to the movement of products and to placing on the market for the consumer

a) – Date of placing on the market for the consumer.
The wines are placed on the market for the consumer according to the provisions of Article D. 645-17 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

b) – Period during which the wines may not move between approved warehouse keepers.
The wines may move between approved warehouse keepers at the earliest on:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	DATE
Rosé and white wines	15 November of the year of harvest
Red wines	1 December of the year of harvest

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The massif of the Corbières constitutes a major geomorphological unit at the north-eastern extremity of the Pyrenees, bounded: - to the west, by the high valley of the Aude; - to the north, by the Languedoc depression followed by the valley of the Aude; - to the south, by the crest line separating the Aude department from that of the Pyrénées-Orientales; - to the east, by the Mediterranean Sea. In this massif, three summits dominate a landscape of plateaus cut by gorges or wider valleys, of small depressions, of crests and of a set of more or less isolated hills around Mouthoumet, Durban, Tuchan, Boutenac: - the peak

of Bugarach, at an altitude of 1,230 metres; - Mont Tauch, at an altitude of 917 metres, to the south, which borders the depression of Tuchan-Paziols; - the peak of Alaric, at an altitude of 600 metres, at the northern limit of the geographical area. In this very compartmentalised relief, over a distance of 60 kilometres from west to east, the altitude decreases, from the peak of Bugarach, to the level of the lagoon, then of the sea, around the communes of Peyriac, Leucate and Sigean. The eventful tectonic history of the region, following the uplift of the nearby Pyrenees, explains the geological diversity of the geographical area, which extends within this massif over the territory of 87 communes, to the east of the Aude department. The parcels delimited for the harvesting of the grapes present soils, arising from these geological formations, essentially clayey-calcareous and developed on Eocene molasses. These soils are generally poorly fertile, shallow, stony and well drained. The Mediterranean climate is dry, sunny and hot. The winds are omnipresent: - the Tramontane or Cers, a wind blowing from the west; - the sea wind, blowing mainly in autumn and in spring and bringing humidity and rains. The average annual rainfall increases with altitude. Thus the coast receives on average less than 450 millimetres per year, against more than 700 millimetres for the mountainous zones of the geographical area. The average annual temperatures show a decreasing evolution from east to west, going from 15.4 °C, at the seaside, to 13.4 °C, near Carcassonne. In this tormented landscape, the vine shares the territory with the garrigue and a few olive trees.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

The vine is introduced by the Greek traders in the 2nd century before Jesus Christ, but experiences its true rise with the Roman occupation. The conditions are so favourable for the viticulture of the “Narbonne region” that the production of wine overshadows the Roman production and compels the emperor DOMITIAN, in 92, to demand a limitation of the production. This prosperity lasts until the end of the “Pax romana” (end of the 2nd century). The great invasions, come from the east, the north or the south from the 3rd century to the 8th century, affect the vineyard. Peace returned, the Benedictine and Cistercian abbeys contribute to the development of the vineyard, unfortunately interrupted, again, in the 13th century by the crusade against the Albigensians. The Canal du Midi, opened in 1680, the improvement of the road network in the 18th century, then the arrival of the railway, favour the opening up of the region. The Aude vineyard is then rehabilitated to the detriment of the cultivation of olive trees and cereals. This prosperity is subject to the hazards of the phylloxera crisis and of overproduction, with as its climax the wine crisis of 1907 that imposes on the whole region a deep reorganisation. A defence union is created in the region of the “Corbières” in 1908. After the delimitation of the geographical area, in 1923, recognised at first as designation of origin “vin délimité de qualité supérieure” in 1951, the “Corbières” are recognised as controlled designation of origin by decree of 24 December 1985. The production of about 370,000 hectolitres, for an area of 13,000 hectares, is elaborated, in 2017, by 23 cooperative cellars (for 1,500 declarants and 54 % of the volumes) and 220 estates of independent winegrowers. The red wines represent 87 % of the production. The main varieties, grenache N, lledonner pelut N, mourvèdre N and syrah N, are in the majority and the carignan N variety is limited to 50 %. The rosé wines represent 10 % of the volumes, that is to say about 36,000 hectolitres. They obey the same grape-variety rules as the red wines, but the proportion of the cinsaut N variety is limited to 75 % of the grape varieties. The white wines represent 3 % of the volumes, that is to say about 11,000 hectolitres.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

The red wine, dry, produced within the limit of 48 hectolitres per hectare, is elaborated by the blending of at least two varieties, of which the carignan N variety frequently present. This variety contributes to the structure of the wines, while the other varieties bring roundness and aromatic complexity. They are wines in general balanced, structured and powerful, often with notes of intense red fruits and of spices. They may be consumed young, but present a good aptitude for ageing. The rosé wine is a dry wine produced within the limit of 50 hectolitres per hectare. Its nose, elegant, is most often marked by floral and fruity notes. The attack on the palate is fresh and continues with a fine roundness. The white wine is a dry wine, produced within the limit of 50 hectolitres per hectare. It is characterised mainly by elegant aromas of white flowers and a balance resting on roundness and finesse.

3° – Causal interactions

The massif of the Corbières forms a natural, historical and cultural barrier with the region of the Roussillon, and its vineyard is open onto the Mediterranean Sea and onto the plain of the Languedoc. Long a frontier with Spain, the region of the Corbières loses its frontier status, in 1659, with the signature of the Treaty of the Pyrenees, which attaches "northern Catalonia" to France. Extended over 60 kilometres, from the Narbonne coast to the gates of Carcassonne, the region of the Corbières offers a succession of varied basins divided into four or five well-differentiated geographical units interlocked in this unique massif. The Mediterranean climate impregnates the whole massif and, except on the summits, the Mediterranean vegetation dominates and disputes the space with the vine at the heart of a very dry region subject to the winds nearly 300 days per year. The producers, over the generations, have built the "Corbières", in this compartmentalised, luminous but difficult whole, where the rare rainy episodes of autumn and spring are sometimes violent. They have known how to establish a reasoned establishment of the varieties, adapting cultivation practices and training methods to the different situations. Thus, the carignan N variety, very present, remains, in the most difficult situations, the variety of predilection perfectly adapted to the hot, dry and windy climate of the zone. In complement, are found the grenache N, mourvèdre N and syrah N varieties. This last, early, is established in the situations presenting deeper and cooler soils. Sensitive to the wind, it is generally trellised. The mourvèdre N variety, later, is found in the hottest soils, on the coastal fringe and in the sheltered situations. Omnipresent, the grenache N variety occupies the meagre and arid hillsides with the carignan N variety. By putting the geographical situations within the appellation into adequacy with the varieties, the winegrowers reveal in the wines the potential of the meagre and stony spaces, which bring to the red wines their structure and their power, and the potential of the deeper and cooler soils, which confer on the rosé wines their characteristic fruity aromas, while valuing the sheltered parcels that permit the expression in the red and rosé wines of the tannic suppleness and of characteristic notes of fruits (in particular of red fruits for the red wines). Finally, the Mediterranean heat permits the obtaining of round and balanced white wines. The complementarity of the varieties is the strength of the wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin "Corbières", renowned wines, for a very long time the preserve of a very developed local trade that permitted their very wide distribution on the French market. The "five sons of Carcassonne", the châteaux of Peyrepertuse, Puylaurens, Quéribus, Termes and Aguilar, from the height of their calcareous crests, testify to the troubled past of the "Corbières", when the Cathar drama was played out on the mountain. The vestiges of the magnificent abbeys of Lagrasse and Fontfroide recall the essential role of the monks in the establishment of the vine, the only plant capable of valuing at best the meagre arid territory left by the garrigue, the moor and the rocks, and that gave the producers of the "Corbières" their pride and their dynamism for the defence of the reputation of their controlled designation of origin.

XI. – Transitional measures

Training methods

The vine parcels planted before 19 April 2001, presenting a planting density lower than 4,000 plants per hectare and/or a spacing between rows greater than 2.50 metres, continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin until they are grubbed up and subject to the foliage height making it possible to have 1.40 square metres of external surface of plant cover for the production of one kilogram of grapes.

2° – Blending of the varieties

On a transitional basis and until the 2015 harvest inclusive, in the blends intended for the red and rosé wines, a variety may not represent more than 85 % of the blend.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin "Corbières" is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled

designation of origin is entered and accompanied by the entry “Appellation d’origine contrôlée”, the whole in very apparent characters.

2° – Particular provisions

a) – The labelling of the wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the name of a smaller geographical unit, subject to: - it being a registered cadastral lieu-dit; - it appearing on the harvest declaration. The name of the registered cadastral lieu-dit is entered immediately after the name of the controlled designation of origin and printed in characters whose dimensions are not greater, both in height and in width, than half those of the characters composing the name of the controlled designation of origin.

b) – The labelling of the wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the name of a larger geographical unit “Languedoc”; the dimensions of this geographical unit are not greater, both in height and in width, than half those of the characters composing the name of the designation of origin.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Prior declaration of parcel allocation

a) – Each operator declares, before 1 February of the year of harvest, to the defence and management body, the list of the parcels allocated to the production of the controlled designation of origin. The declaration is renewable by tacit renewal, except for modifications notified by the operator before 1 February preceding each harvest. This declaration specifies: - the identity of the operator; - the EVV or SIRET number; - the cooperative cellar(s) or vinification structure(s) to which it is, where applicable, a supplier; - for each parcel: the cadastral reference, the area, the year of planting, the variety, the planting density, the spacings on the row and between rows, the identification of the parcels liable to be irrigated. It is accompanied by a copy of the list of the parcels presenting a percentage of dead or missing plants greater than 20 %, established in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

b) – The declaration of renunciation as provided for in the specifications of the controlled designations of origin “Rivesaltes”, “Muscat de Rivesaltes”, “Grand Roussillon”, “Fitou” and “Corbières Boutenac” is equivalent to a prior declaration of parcel allocation in controlled designation of origin “Corbières”, for the parcels respecting the production conditions of the controlled designation of origin “Corbières” and subject to being lodged before 15 August preceding the harvest, or until the start of the harvest in the event of a climatic accident, with the approved control body and with the defence and management body of the controlled designation of origin “Corbières”.

2. Declaration of renunciation to produce

The operator may declare, to the defence and management body, the parcels for which it renounces to produce the controlled designation of origin, until 15 August preceding the harvest, or until the start of the harvest in the event of a climatic accident. This declaration specifies for each parcel whether it is intended for the production of a more general controlled designation of origin. The defence and management body transmits this declaration as soon as possible to the defence and management body of the more general controlled designation of origin, as well as to the approved control body for the more general controlled designation of origin.

3. Claim declaration

The claim declaration must be sent to the defence and management body at the latest on 1 February of the year following that of the harvest and at least fifteen days before the first transaction or packaging declaration. This declaration may be partial, by colour (rosé, red, white wine). It indicates: - the appellation claimed; - the volume of the wine; - the EVV or SIRET number; - the name and address of the applicant; - the place of storage of the wine. It is accompanied by: - a copy of the harvest declaration; - and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for the buyers of grapes and musts; - for the accredited operators having allocated their parcels to one of the following appellations: “Fitou”, “Boutenac”, the prior declaration of parcel allocation of the appellations mentioned above.

4. Prior declaration of bulk transactions or of removals

Every operator wishing to market in bulk a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin must make to the approved control body and to the defence and management body of the AOC Corbières a transaction declaration for the lot concerned within a time limit fixed in the control plan. In all cases, this declaration must be received within the 5 working days following the contractualisation and at least 10 working days before the removal. It specifies: - the complete identity and address of the selling operator; - the SIRET number and, where applicable, the CVI number; - the volume, the colour, where applicable the vintage; - the complete identity and address of the buying operator including the SIRET number.

5. Packaging declaration

Every operator wishing to package a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin must make to the approved control body and to the defence and management body of the AOC Corbières a packaging declaration for the lot concerned at the latest ten working days after the operation. The operators carrying out more than 12 packagings per year are exempted from this declaration obligation, but send monthly a summary declaration.

6. Declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

Every operator wishing to carry out a dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin must make the declaration thereof to the approved control body at least ten working days before the dispatch. The operator must specify the volumes concerned. It specifies: - the complete identity and address of the selling operator; - the SIRET number and, where applicable, the CVI number; - the volume, the colour, where applicable the vintage; - the complete identity and address of the buying operator including the SIRET number.

7. Fallback (repli) declaration

Every operator wishing to market a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin under a more general appellation makes the declaration thereof at least eight working days before this fallback to the defence and management body, and to the defence and management body and to the approved control body of the more general appellation, in order to ensure the monitoring thereof. It specifies for the wine concerned the appellation, the colour, where applicable the vintage, the volume, the place of storage of the wine. It is accompanied by: - for the vinifying operators, a copy of the claim declaration in the initial appellation; - for the non-vinifying operators, the extract of the stock accounts or the copy(ies) of the bulk transaction in the appellation.

8. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin must make the declaration thereof to the defence and management body and to the approved control body at the latest fifteen days after this downgrading.

9. Declaration of the derogatory pruning method for the grenache blanc B and grenache N varieties

Every operator declares to the defence and management body, on the prior declaration of parcel allocation, before 1 February preceding the harvest, the list of the parcels planted with the grenache blanc B and grenache N varieties (subject to coulure) and that are pruned by replacing a maximum of 3 spurs by a long cane bearing a maximum of 5 free eyes.

10. Prior declarations relating to pruning

Each operator declares to the defence and management body, on the prior declaration of parcel allocation: - the list of the parcels intended to be trained in Royat cordon before the end of the 2nd year following that of the planting; - the list of the parcels trained in goblet and whose training is going to be “transformed” into Royat cordon, before 1 February preceding the “transformation” pruning.

II. – Keeping of registers

The following registers are filled in regularly and are kept available for the approved control body:

1. Register relating to the transitional provisions

List of the parcels being the subject of transitional provisions relating to the training method.

1. Ripeness monitoring

Ripeness-monitoring register with the reading of the sugar richness of the grapes per cultivation unit, or recording of the sugar richness of the grapes at the harvest, or analysis of the sugar content and of the alcoholic strength by volume per container.

2. Cellar plan

Cellar plan permitting in particular the number, the designation and the capacity of the containers to be identified.

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1 – Belonging of the planted (and allocated) parcels to the delimited area.	Documentary check and check in the field.
A2 – Claimable production potential (grape varieties and proportion rules, monitoring of the transitional measures, planting density and trellising).	Documentary check and check in the field.
Prior declaration of parcel allocation.	Documentary check and check in the field.
A3 – Processing, ageing, packaging and storage facility. — Belonging of the place of vinification to the geographical area or to the immediate proximity area.	Documentary check.
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard. — Pruning.	Check in the field.
Missing vines.	Documentary check, check in the field.
Average maximum load per parcel.	Check in the field.
Irrigation.	Documentary check and check in the field.
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes. — Ripeness of the grapes.	Documentary check.
B3 – Harvest declaration and claim declaration. — Authorised yield.	Documentary check.
Claim declaration and harvest declaration.	Documentary check.
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
At the stage of the transaction or of the packaging.	Documentary and/or analytical check.
At the stage of the transaction or of the packaging.	Organoleptic examination.
Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory.	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all the lots.

II. – References concerning the control structure

National Institute of Origin and Quality (INAO)
TSA 30003
93555 – MONTREUIL Cedex
Tel: (33) (0)1.73.30.38.00

Fax: (33) (0)1.73.30.38.04
Email: info@inao.gouv.fr

BUREAU VERITAS CERTIFICATION FRANCE SAS
Immeuble le « Guillaumet »
60, avenue du Général de Gaulle
92046 – PARIS-LA-DÉFENSE
Tel: 01 41 97 00 73
Fax: 01 41 97 08 32

This body is accredited by the COFRAC with regard to the criteria defined by standard no. 5-0051.

The check of compliance with the present specification is carried out by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence, on behalf of the INAO, on the basis of an approved control plan. The control plan sets out the self-checks carried out by the operators on their own activity and the internal checks carried out under the responsibility of the defence and management body. It indicates the external checks carried out by the third-party body as well as the analytical and organoleptic examinations. The whole of the checks is carried out by sampling. Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory are the subject of a systematic analytical and organoleptic check.